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Rhetorical Rationale

The primary goal of my document is to serve as an introduction to the code editor *Vim*, which is a niche tool designed to edit source code in a manner that minimizes the usage of the mouse. This tool requires a dense set of knowledge for even novice usage, which serves as a barrier to adoption for the general programming population. Thus it is my goal to author a professional document in order to assist my fellow programmers in learning to use the program, which should enhance their efficiency and grow the local community surrounding a personal interest.

The genre of *Technical Guide* was ideal for conveying the skills required to begin using *Vim*. These types of documents compact a large amount of information into a functional format that provides their audiences with information that they can immediately use. The topic chosen is primarily a functional one, and thus requires a functional manner of document to properly convey its intricacies. When learning a new skill one must continuously practice, growing their ability in small portions until they eventually become proficient. A guide presents information in a serialized manner, building an understanding by covering a single aspect of its topic within each section. This format grows an audience's comprehension of the program incrementally, allowing them to become accustomed to the information presented before requiring a rigorous understanding. This gradual growth is essential an introduction to *Vim*, as attempting to learn the entire program initially is impractical and enormously challenging.

The guide is designed for an audience of my peers within the School of Computer Science at UCF. Specifically those who have prior experience utilizing code editors like *VS Code* or *CLion* to complete their school assignments. This group originates from a technical

background and is comfortable interacting with their computer through advanced methods.

The content is presented within as a means in which to increase one's efficiency in writing code. The chapter "Rhetorical Nature of Technical and Professional Writing" states that "the writer must consider what will persuade the reader most" when attempting to convey a point of view to their audience. It is the adoption and mastering of the application that the guide attempts to persuade to the audience. This eventual promise of a performance enhancement serves as the primary appeal of the document. Such a goal will provides the motivation to practice for the amount required to properly learn the skills addressed. While the surface level use of *Vim* can be challenging to learn in a single sitting, the overall the amount of knowledge required is a manageable amount.

Establishing an amateur use of the program is the goal of the document, but the tool itself contains leagues of depth and complex behavior. Much like other examples of professional software, for instance *Photoshop* or *Blender*, it would take thousands of hours of investment to master *Vim* in it's entirety. Such an environment is bound to draw inquiry from an audience that is engaged with the content, as each presentation of a feature can easily lead to a multitude of additional questions.

The guide prioritized basic usage of *Vim*. The program is designed to allow a user to edit source code in the most efficient manner possible. Due to the program's inherent nature, there are an infinite variety of strategies to utilize when attempting to work as efficiently as possible. The obvious action is usually not the most effective, but in order to recognize an improved alternative a user must posses a nuanced understanding of the numerous intertwined systems within *Vim*. Thus I have chosen to provide an introduction to those fundamental systems required for proficiency in general usage.

Specifically, the most elementary commands were chosen to be enumerated and explained. Much like learning to walk, the audience must first understand the rudimentary behaviors essential to simple operation before being able to complete entire, multistage

maneuvers. The guide introduced *Vim* as a concept, establishing its purpose, origins, and role within a development ecosystem. Once the audience gained a familiarity with the program, and hopefully installed it, the guide begins covering fundamental concepts required to interact with the application. To operate *Vim* one must perform a series of precise actions that behave differently depending on context in which they are used. Essentially each key press is a command relative to the current 'mode' of the program. Thus once the concept of 'mode' had been established, the guide gradually increased the complexity of the subject matter it covered. Beginning with basic navigation, to rudimentary editing, and finally advanced composites of the two.

To properly present the information required for an introduction to *Vim* a both textual and graphic sequences were necessitated. For abstract concepts, like 'Modal Editing' or the development environment within *VSCo*de, text performed adequately. It was within the latter sections, which enumerated numerous command in sequence and global control flow, that visual nature of the guide was utilized to great effect. Gerdes notes that due to limitations in space within a document information must occasionally be presented in a compacted manner, requiring authors to consider sentence structure and tone. In order to preserve the concise organization of the guide, charts served as the ideal delivery method for the dense set of commands presented, streamlining their presentation in a manner which conveyed their use prominently without increasing visual clutter. Each cell conveyed the exact behavior of its respective command utilizing a terse, focused tone. For the instructions that required the audience to interact with *VSCo*de annotated screenshots communicated the specific actions to be performed in order to access the extension presented in the guide. Encapsulating each section were bolded headers that adeptly outlined the content in which they prepositioned, allowing for efficient navigation throughout the guide.

Works Cited

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